



Rahul Bajaj

Chairman,
BAJAJ AUTO

HEMANT CHAWLA

Difficult to say. There are industries which give us a glimmer of hope. Many others don't. Exports are down. Another danger is in the over-indebtedness of many corporates. But I sense Indian industry is essentially optimistic and is probing growth wherever chances exist.

Probably yes, though 2009 will continue to be a difficult year for Indian industry.

Not completely, as exports and IT are dependent on global growth. The West may recover only by 2010. Fund flow and quantum will depend on the situation in the developed world.

The turnaround is likely to take place by the end of 2009.

I would monitor developments in the US, Europe and China, IIP and quarterly results. Unemployment figures, domestic and global, and growth in industries like steel, cement and automobiles would be signs to keep in mind.

- Ensure that banks start lending to SMEs and retail customers at a reasonable rate.
- Enforce better governance, improve efficiency and reduce corruption.
- Slash money spent on non-merit subsidies and use them to fund core projects.



Prashant Ruia

Group Chief Executive,
ESSAR GROUP

BANDEEP SINGH

I feel the rise in the markets is just one of the indicators that the Government and India Inc are both taking the necessary steps to cope with the global recession. It is too early to extrapolate market movements to conclude that the economy is on the path of revival.

Yes. I feel the numbers will not plummet any further. Having said that, recovery will be gradual and the pace will be much slower than during the upturn.

Given that exports constitute 17 per cent of the GDP we cannot claim to be insulated completely. A strong rural economy and a series of fiscal stimuli have, however, reduced the impact.

We are on our way to recovery and I maintain that a complete turnaround will be witnessed by 2011.

One of the important signs of revival will be growth in consumer demand, both domestic and international. This will have a ripple effect in improving business confidence and enhancing corporate margins and overall liquidity.

- Push for deadlines and speedy clearances of infrastructure projects.
- Revamp and revive disinvestment to create resources for the social sector.
- Weed out non-merit subsidies and introduce technology to deliver the rest.



Uday Kotak

VC & MD, KOTAK
MAHINDRA BANK

UMESH GOSWAMI

The glimmer of hope and the feelgood factor is for real because the earthquake is over.

Yes. The darkest part of the night is over but it is too early to call it a dawn.

Yes. As long as there are no new global accidents like Lehman Brothers and AIG, which could ruin sentiments. We will, however, grow slower, at 5-5.5 per cent in '09-10.

In the context of contracting world growth, 5.5 per cent growth is very good. The sentiment is that we have seen the bottom.

Cars and two-wheeler sales, softening interest rates and credit offtake are good signs. The moment investment demand picks up—new projects announced and finance raised—you will know we have turned the corner.

- Prepare a plan for disinvestment and give a fillip to capital markets.
- Encourage banks to drop deposit rates which will bring down lending rates.
- Take fiscal measures to ensure investment demand.